

Name: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____ / 30

Reading Comprehension Test

2 Samuel - Bible
by Old Testament

Directions: Circle the letter of the best answer for each question.

Section 1: Easy

1. Who becomes king after Saul dies?

- A. Absalom
- B. Joab
- C. David
- D. Nathan

2. Which city does David capture and make his capital?

- A. Jerusalem
- B. Shiloh
- C. Ramah
- D. Jericho

3. What sacred object does David bring to Jerusalem?

- A. Goliath's armor
- B. Saul's spear
- C. Samuel's scroll
- D. The ark of God

4. Which prophet confronted David after his sin with Bathsheba?

- A. Elijah
- B. Nathan
- C. Samuel
- D. Jonah

5. Who was Bathsheba's husband before David took her?

- A. Joab
- B. Abner
- C. Uriah
- D. Zadok

6. Which son of David rebelled and tried to take the kingdom?

- A. Solomon
- B. Amnon
- C. Chileab
- D. Absalom

7. Who was David's main army commander through much of 2 Samuel?

- A. Joab
- B. Jonathan
- C. Eli
- D. Nabal

8. Which son of David and Bathsheba later becomes important as the next king?

- A. Absalom
- B. Solomon
- C. Saul
- D. Ish-bosheth

9. What does David buy near the end of 2 Samuel to stop a plague?

- A. A royal robe
- B. A new chariot
- C. A Philistine sword
- D. A threshing floor

10. How does David respond when he hears Absalom is dead?

- A. He laughs because the rebellion is over
- B. He immediately holds a feast
- C. He mourns deeply for his son
- D. He refuses to believe Absalom was related to him

Section 2: Medium

11. Why did David punish the man who claimed to have killed Saul?

- A. David wanted Saul's armor for himself and hoped to hide it from Israel
- B. David believed the man had dishonored the Lord's anointed king
- C. David thought Jonathan had ordered the killing
- D. David was trying to impress the Philistines

12. Why was David first king over Judah before all Israel accepted him?

- A. Israel had no tribes left except Judah
- B. David refused to rule anyone outside Bethlehem
- C. The Philistines appointed David over Judah only
- D. Saul's house still had supporters, so the kingdom was divided for a time

13. What did God's covenant with David promise?

- A. David would never face family trouble even after serious sin
- B. David's house and throne would have a lasting future in God's plan
- C. David would build every temple in Israel himself
- D. David's sons would never need correction

14. Why did David show kindness to Mephibosheth?

- A. David remembered his covenant friendship with Jonathan
- B. Mephibosheth paid David a large ransom after many years in hiding
- C. Mephibosheth had defeated Goliath for David
- D. Joab ordered David to spare all of Saul's family

15. How did David try to cover up his sin with Bathsheba?

- A. He sent Uriah into dangerous battle so Uriah would die
- B. He confessed immediately to all Israel in front of the whole army
- C. He gave Uriah Saul's old crown
- D. He moved the ark back to Shiloh

16. Why was Nathan's story about the rich man and the poor man's lamb effective?

- A. It proved David had never understood shepherds after growing up with sheep

- B. It made Joab confess to killing Uriah
- C. It convinced Bathsheba to leave Jerusalem
- D. It let David judge the injustice before realizing the story exposed his own sin

17. What was David's response when Nathan said, 'You are the man'?

- A. He blamed Uriah for everything and denied any responsibility
- B. He admitted that he had sinned against the Lord
- C. He ordered Nathan to leave Israel
- D. He claimed kings never need forgiveness

18. How does Amnon's sin against Tamar affect David's family?

- A. It immediately unites all David's sons around peace and forgiveness
- B. It causes Samuel to return from the dead
- C. It begins a chain of bitterness, revenge, and family violence
- D. It makes Absalom more loyal to David

19. How did Absalom win support before his rebellion?

- A. He served quietly as a priest at the altar without seeking attention
- B. He defeated every enemy without help
- C. He gave Saul's old spear to David
- D. He acted charming and promised people better justice

20. Why did David leave Jerusalem when Absalom rebelled?

- A. He wanted to avoid turning the city into a battlefield and trusted God with the outcome
- B. He no longer cared about the ark of God or the worship of Israel
- C. He planned to join the Philistines permanently
- D. He believed Absalom had been anointed by Samuel

21. What did Hushai do during Absalom's rebellion?

- A. He killed Joab in single combat during the first day of battle
- B. He helped David by frustrating Ahithophel's counsel
- C. He stole the ark and hid it in a cave
- D. He crowned himself king in Hebron

22. Why was Joab's killing of Absalom complicated?

- A. Joab thought Absalom was a Philistine and did not recognize him
- B. Absalom had already surrendered to David
- C. David had commanded the army to deal gently with Absalom
- D. Nathan had ordered Joab to kill every rebel

23. Why did Joab rebuke David after Absalom's death?

- A. David's grief made the loyal soldiers feel ashamed instead of honored
- B. David had refused to mourn Absalom at all after hearing the news
- C. David wanted Joab to become king
- D. David ordered the army to return to Philistia

24. Why was David's census near the end of the book wrong?

- A. Counting people was always forbidden in every situation for every leader
- B. Joab had asked David to count the ark instead
- C. The people of Israel had all moved away
- D. It showed pride and misplaced trust in military strength

25. Why did David insist on paying for the threshing floor?

- A. He wanted to make Joab angry by buying land without asking him
- B. He wanted Solomon to own every farm in Israel
- C. He would not offer to the Lord something that cost him nothing
- D. He planned to build a palace there the next day

Section 3: Hard

26. What tension runs through David's life in 2 Samuel?

- A. David is God's chosen king, yet his own sin brings real damage and grief
- B. David is never forgiven for anything he does wrong, even after confession
- C. David has no enemies after Saul dies
- D. David only matters because Joab is stronger than he is

27. How does 2 Samuel show both mercy and justice?

- A. God ignores every evil act once a person becomes king in Jerusalem
- B. David never forgives anyone who hurts him
- C. Only foreign nations experience consequences
- D. God keeps His covenant promises while still confronting sin and allowing consequences

28. What does David's kindness to Mephibosheth reveal about covenant loyalty?

- A. Covenant loyalty only lasts when it is politically useful
- B. Faithful love can honor promises even toward someone weak or unable to repay
- C. David was afraid Mephibosheth would defeat him in battle
- D. Saul's family had earned a palace by obeying David

29. What warning does Absalom's rebellion give about appearances?

- A. Good looks and public charm can hide pride, manipulation, and a hungry heart for power
- B. Anyone with long hair is automatically evil in every biblical story and can never repent
- C. Popular leaders never become dangerous
- D. A king should always believe the most charming son

30. Why is the ending at the threshing floor hopeful even after judgment?

- A. It proves David's census was wise after all
- B. It shows Israel never needed sacrifices
- C. It removes all future suffering from David's family
- D. It shows repentance, costly worship, and God's mercy stopping the plague